

LKA Invoices

Future enhancements roadmap: everything discussed and not yet built

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How to read this. Items are grouped by area. **Priority:** **Next** do soon, **Later** when useful, **Someday** only if the firm needs it. **Effort:** S = about a day, M = a few days, L = a week or more. **Cost:** **Free** stays on the free Firebase Spark and Netlify plans, **Small fee** a yearly or per-use charge, **Paid** needs a paid plan or per-transaction fees.

1. At a glance: recommended order

#	Enhancement	Why	Effort	Cost
1	Restore tool	Turns a backup file into a working portal again, without a developer.	M	Free
2	Automatic weekly backup by email	Backups no longer depend on someone remembering.	M	Free
3	Recurring invoices	Monthly / quarterly retainer clients get their draft created automatically.	M	Free
4	Install as an app (PWA) + mobile navigation	Home-screen icon, quick to open, easier on phones.	S–M	Free
5	Faster Reports (monthly summaries)	Reports cost ~12 reads instead of thousands as data grows.	M	Free
6	Firebase App Check	Blocks scripted access to the database from outside the website.	S	Free
7	Usage meter	Shows how close the portal is to the free limits.	S	Free
8	Year archive	Keeps the database small for decades.	M	Free

2. Data, backup and continuity

2.1 Restore tool **Next** **Free**

Today, Settings → Backup downloads a JSON file, but there is no way to load it back. The restore tool closes that gap and is the key to recovering from losing a Firebase project.

- **Who:** owners only (ADMIN with Revenue permission). Runs through a Netlify function using the Admin SDK, or as a command-line script for a brand-new project.
- **Step 1, check:** upload the backup file; the tool validates it (format version, firm settings, counters, clients, invoices, users) and shows a dry-run summary: "412 clients, 3,180 invoices, 4 users will be restored".

- **Step 2, choose:** *Restore into an empty project* (disaster recovery) or *Restore only missing records* (never overwrites existing data).
- **Step 3, restore:** writes in batches of 500, keeping the original IDs, invoice numbers and financial-year counters so numbering continues correctly. Progress bar; safe to resume if interrupted.
- **Users:** user records are recreated as invites; staff sign in again with Google or set a new password. Roles and permissions are restored.
- **Audit:** a RESTORE entry is written to the activity log.
- **Free-plan note:** the free plan allows 20,000 writes a day. Restores larger than that continue automatically the next day.

2.2 Automatic weekly backup by email Next Free

- A Netlify **scheduled function** runs every Sunday night (IST), reads all data with the Admin SDK and builds the same backup file as Settings → Backup, compressed (.json.gz).
- Emails it to two owner addresses through a free email service (e.g. Brevo, 300 emails/day free). The SMTP key lives only in Netlify environment variables.
- Owners choose the addresses and can turn it off in Settings → Backup; the page shows "Last automatic backup: Sunday 28 Sep, 11:00 pm ✓".
- Cost: one read per record per week (e.g. 4,000 reads, well within 50,000/day).
- If the file ever grows too large for an email attachment, it switches to a private Google Drive folder instead.

2.3 Other data items

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Faster Reports	Keep running monthly totals (billed, received, by client) updated when invoices are issued or paid. Reports then read ~12 summary records instead of every invoice.	Next	M
Year archive	Export a closed financial year to a file and, optionally, remove it from the database to stay well under the 1 GB free storage.	Later	M
Usage meter	Settings card estimating storage used and today's reads/writes against the free limits.	Later	S
Excel / Tally export	Invoice and payment export formatted for Tally or other accounting software.	Later	M
Download a client's data	One file with everything about a client, for privacy requests.	Someday	S

2.4 Account continuity checklist (owner actions, no code)

- Add a **second Owner** to the Firebase project (Project settings → Users and permissions).
- Google account: recovery phone and email, 2-Step Verification, printed backup codes in the office safe.
- Netlify and GitHub: second team member / collaborator, 2FA on, recovery codes saved.
- Offline "break-glass" pack: latest backup, Netlify environment variable values, a code ZIP, backup codes.

- Remove `SETUP_CODE` from Netlify after setup; rotate the Firebase admin key yearly.

3. Recurring invoices Next Free

- Mark a client service as recurring: monthly accounting, quarterly GST filing, yearly audit/ITR.
- Each template holds client, service lines, amount, frequency, day of month and an end date (optional).
- On the due day the portal creates a **draft** (never issues automatically) and shows it in the notification bell and on Home: "4 recurring drafts ready to review".
- One click to review and issue; the period is filled in, e.g. "Accounting services – October 2026".
- Runs on a free Netlify scheduled function, or when an admin opens the portal.

4. Mobile experience

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Install as an app (PWA)	Home-screen icon with the firm logo, opens full-screen, loads quickly. No app store needed.	Next	S
Bottom navigation bar	On phones: Home · Invoices · + · Clients · More, instead of the top menu.	Next	S
Sticky action buttons	Save / Create / Issue fixed at the bottom of forms; larger tap targets.	Later	S
Swipe actions	Swipe right to mark paid, left to send a reminder.	Someday	M

5. Security

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Firebase App Check	Only requests from the real website (verified by free reCAPTCHA) can reach the database.	Next	S
Login alerts	Email the owners when someone signs in from a new device.	Later	M

6. Invoicing

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Part / advance payments	Record several payments against one invoice; balance due shown on the invoice and PDF.	Later	M
TDS summary	TDS deducted per client and per quarter, for Form 26AS reconciliation.	Later	S
Credit notes	The proper GST way to correct an issued invoice, with its own number series.	Later	M

Quotation / estimate	Separate "QTN" series that converts into an invoice in one click.	Later	M
Discount line	Optional discount on an invoice before tax.	Someday	S
Assessment year field	Dropdown for ITR work, e.g. "ITR filing, AY 2026-27".	Later	S
Remember last service	Pre-fill the last service and price used for a client.	Later	S

7. Clients

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Compliance calendar	GST return and ITR due dates per client, with Home reminders such as "5 clients' GSTR-3B due in 3 days".	Later	M
Document checklist	Text checklist of documents received (PAN, Form 16, bank statements). No file uploads, to stay on the free plan.	Someday	S
Client avatars	Coloured initials next to client names in lists.	Someday	S

8. PDF and branding

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Invoice designs	Choose Classic, Modern or Minimal in Settings.	Someday	M
Signature and seal	Signature image and company seal, plus date/time stamp. Stored in the database (small images), not Cloud Storage.	Later	S
Bilingual PDF	Headings in Telugu and English.	Someday	M

9. Everyday use, engagement and help

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Effort
Autosave drafts	Save while typing, with a "Saved ✓" tick.	Later	S
Undo	"Invoice deleted · Undo (5 s)" after delete, mark paid or cancel.	Later	M
Bulk select	Tick several invoices: download PDFs as a zip, mark paid, export.	Later	M
Live invoice preview	PDF preview beside the form on desktop, updating as you type.	Someday	M
Due-date calendar	Month view of invoice due dates, events and compliance deadlines.	Later	M

Browser notifications	Optional pop-ups for task reminders and overdue invoices while the portal is open.	Someday	S
Year-in-review	Each April: total billed, top clients, busiest month, average days to get paid.	Later	S
Collection streak	"Paid on time: 8 clients in a row".	Someday	S
Accent colour	Each user picks an accent colour besides light/dark theme.	Someday	S
Guided tour	4–5 tooltips for first-time users.	Someday	S
Settings completeness meter	"Firm profile 80% complete: add UPI ID to show the QR code".	Later	S

10. Communication

Enhancement	Description	Priority	Cost
Send email from the portal	Email with the PDF attached directly, instead of opening the mail app. Uses Brevo (300/day free) via a Netlify function.	Later	Free
WhatsApp Business API	Automatic WhatsApp reminders without opening WhatsApp.	Someday	Per message

11. Bigger future steps

Enhancement	Description	Cost
Custom domain	e.g. invoices.lingeshwarca.in.	≈ ₹800–1,200 / year
Client portal	Clients sign in to view and pay invoices and download statements.	Free (L effort)
Online payments	Razorpay / Cashfree; invoice marked paid automatically.	Gateway fees
Multi-branch / multi-firm	Separate numbering and branding per office.	Free (L effort)
E-invoicing (IRN) & e-way bill	Only if required by GST turnover limits.	Depends on provider

Ground rules for every enhancement: Firebase stays on the free Spark plan (no Cloud Functions, Cloud Storage or managed backups); secrets stay in Netlify environment variables; each batch is built locally, shown with screenshots, tested, and deployed only after approval.

12. Already built (for reference)

Payment reminders · receipts · client statements · Reports page · client tags, notes and CSV import · PAID/DRAFT watermarks and clickable UPI link · Home "Today" panel, charts, goal ring, weekly summary, activity feed, nudges, milestones · search palette (Ctrl+K) and shortcuts · notification bell · editable message templates · activity log · duplicate invoice · due-date presets · skeleton loaders, empty states, status colours, overdue badges, confetti · floating "+" on phones · inline help tips · three access levels (owner, admin without revenue, staff).